18.7 Schizophrenia

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The voices tell me people are poisoning my food." **Objective** • Hearing voices • Suspicious, refuses meals • Talks to people no one else can see	**ACTUAL** **Impaired verbal communication** related to disordered thinking and hallucinations as evidenced by responding to voices and incoherent speech.	Gets his needs across clearly and says the distressing voices are less.	• Speak in short, clear sentences. • Do not argue with the delusions; acknowledge how he feels and gently present reality. • Ask what the voices are saying, especially any commands to harm. • Give antipsychotics as prescribed and watch for side effects. • If he is suspicious, offer sealed food or let him serve himself.	Gets his needs across: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I prefer to stay alone." **Objective** • Keeps away from others • Stays in his room	**ACTUAL** **Social isolation** related to withdrawal and suspiciousness as evidenced by avoiding others.	Joins one group activity a day.	• Start with one-to-one contact. • Bring him into small groups bit by bit. • Praise him for joining in.	Joins an activity: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Hears voices telling him what to do • Agitated	**RISK** **Risk for other-directed violence** as evidenced by risk factors: command hallucinations and suspiciousness.	Does not harm anyone.	• Watch for early signs of agitation. • Use de-escalation. • If ordered, follow the policy for rapid tranquillisation.	No violence: **goal met**.